

IN21-S3-PL2301
Planning Theory

Socio-Spatial Theory

ATCHUVELY TOWN

Assessment 05

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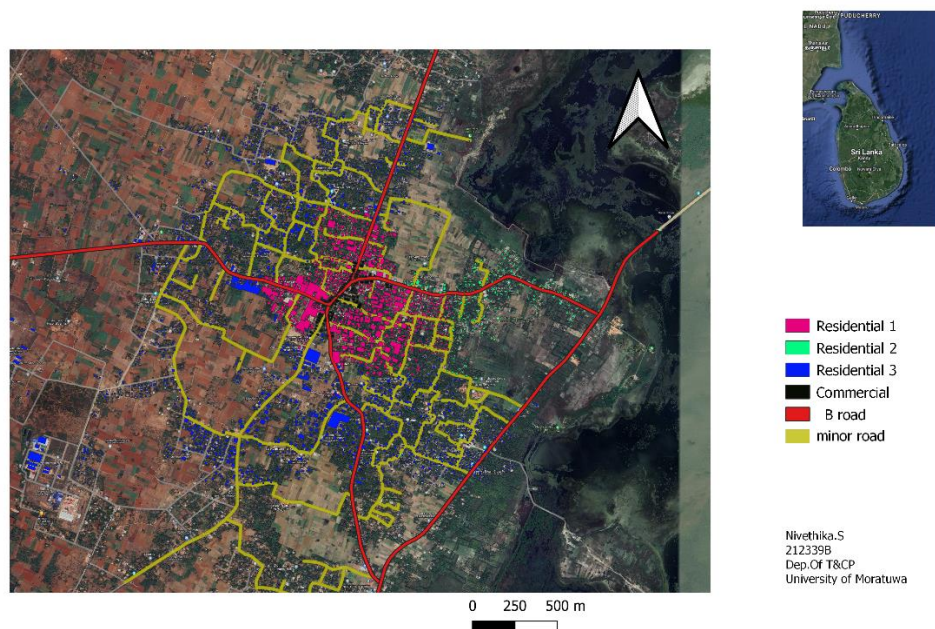
Introduction

The purpose of socio-spatial theory is to explain the observable distribution pattern of residences of specific social groups in towns. For this study, I choose Atchuvely town in Jaffna district. 80% of Hindus, 18% of Christians and the 2% of Moors are the different social groups living in this town. Studying the physical characteristics and features of this communities helps to identify the residential pattern of the Atchuvely town.

Observed Residential types

By studying physical characteristics of settlements, lifestyle of different social groups, and a clear understanding about the nature of the living environment helps to analysis the residential pattern of the Atchuvely town. According to this observation, 3 main residential types can be observed in this selected region. These 3 residential types are divided by the social groups' activities, movements, and the physical characteristics of the housing in the Atchuvely region.

Distribution of Different Residential Patterns - Atchuvely



The ¼ right side part of the map shows Thondaimaanaru lagoon. There is a small amount of fishery family's distributions can be seen near that lagoon area. That community shows some different physical characteristics than other social groups. That area was identified as Residential 2 on the map. Residential 1 indicates the community lives very close to the commercial core of the town. The livelihood of most of the people in this region is agriculture. Lot of agricultural lands can be seen in the regional map. Residential 3 indicates the agricultural community around the town. Commercial area is located middle part of the town and all the commercial activities happens there. All social groups activities organized towards the commercial core of the town.

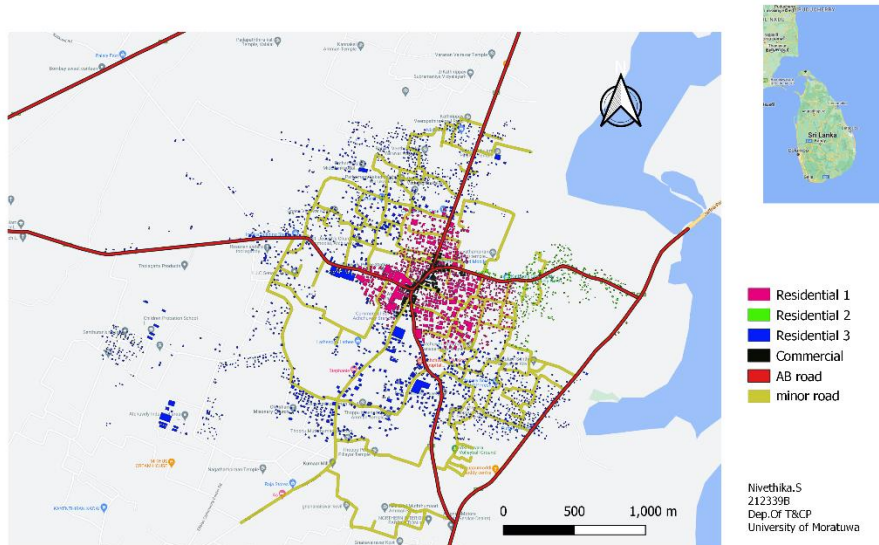
Features of the residential types

Characteristics	Residential 1	Residential 2	Residential 3
Road types Width Accessibility Character	Lot of 6m width good condition, carpet roads and sub roads can be seen. High public usage.	3 minor tar roads with 4m width and others are gravel roads are very narrow and poor maintenance. Most of the time empty roads can be observed.	Many 6m width carpet roads and 4m width concrete roads can be observed in this zone. These roads are mostly used for agricultural purposes.
Plot Sizes Type Character	1. Comparatively small plots than other residential types. Nearly 0.25 Acre plots can be observed. 2. Light weight Brown color Chalky soil spread in this zone. 3. Slightly above from the sea level	1. Commonly 0.5 Acre plots can be seen in this zone. 2. Moist loam soil spread throughout this zone. 3. Low land. Very close to Thondaimaanaru lagoon.	1. Very large plots can be observed in this zone. Nearly 0.8-1.0 Acre land plots can be seen. 2. Prosperous red soil scattered throughout this zone. 3. Comparatively slope lands. Far from coastal zone.
Residence Size Character	1. Single-storey houses are usually found. There are countable 2 storied houses are there. Newly constructed houses are built as 2 storey buildings. 2. There is an open space in front of the houses usually observed and that open space commonly used as personal vehicle park for that house owner.	1. Very old Single-storey houses are usually found. The thickness of the house walls is very high. Nearly 15-20cm. 2. Most of the houses are built in the center part of the plots. A very large open space can be observed around the house. Comparatively there is no recreational activities happen in that area.	1. Single-storey houses are commonly found. The height of the houses is comparatively higher than other zones. Nearly 3-3.5 m. 2. Mostly houses are built in the center or one corner of the plots. Other bare land used for home gardening. A Home Garden is usually observed in front of each residence.
Housing Designs	1. Clay tile roofing can be observed. 2. Averagely 3m height housings can be seen. Lot of glass windows can be seen.	1. Asbestos cement sheet roofing is commonly observed in this zone. 2. Comparatively small houses can be observed. Nearly 2-	1. Clay tile roofing commonly observed. 2. Many wood windows can be seen to increase the air flow inside the house. Comparatively high natural light power

	3.Walls are painted in different colors.	2.5m wall height houses. 2 or 3 wood windows per house can be seen. Light power is very low Inside the house.	can be seen inside the house.
Material used in the house units	Title roof Glass windows Wood double doors Grill Gates	Asbestos roof Wood windows Wood single doors	Title roof Wood Windows Wood single doors Large Wood gates
Quality of the built environment	Comparatively high-quality infrastructure developments housing environment. Clearly divided lands. Areas are a little bit busier than other zones.	Poor housing environment. Old housing pattern infrastructure.	Good Built environment surrounded by nature. Eco friendly buildup environment.
Use of open space	Open space used as vehicle parking slot.	Open space is not used for any recreational activities. Mostly they are bare lands. Soil type is also not suitable for agriculture.	Open space is used for gardening and other agricultural purposes.
Community lifestyles	People who live in this zone mostly work in government sectors and the service sectors. Area is looking little busy and active.	People who live in this area mostly do fishing for their livelihood purpose. Mostly the zone looking more silent and peaceful.	This zone people do Agriculture for their livelihood purpose. Eco friendly environment. Usually, people working in agricultural lands can be seen very often.
Land prices	Very high. Because it is very close to commercial lands and the center of the town. Comparatively high rents in this zone.	Comparatively low price. Low land. Often affected by Floods in the rainy season.	Very high price. Very prosperous agricultural lands have more demand in this region. Lease agricultural lands for agriculture and earn money is a common process happens in this zone.

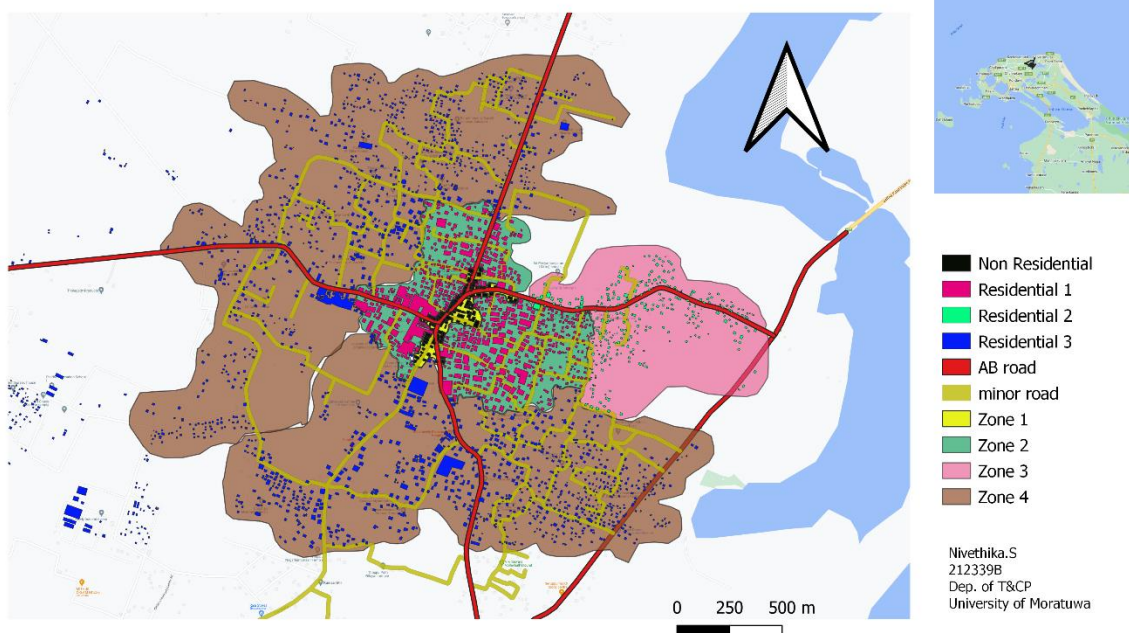
✚ Location of the different types of residential neighborhoods

Distribution of Different Residential Patterns - Atchuvely



✚ Identified zones based on the residential types

Distribution of Different Residential Types Atchuvely



Overall distribution of residential patterns in Atchuvely region

Most of the residences in the Atchuvely region represent Residential 3 housing type. It consists of a larger Agricultural community. This type of residential captures a large part of the Region. The residential type 1 is the increasing residential type in this zone. The scattered of this type residential is slightly increasing in recent days can be observed. Because this zone is immediately next to the Commercial zone of the town. The distribution of residential 2 mainly covers the fishing community in that region. Reduction of this residential type 2 can be observed in recent days. Because of its poor infrastructure facilities, poor housing patterns and mainly this area is affected by flood in heavy rainy season. Because these residencials are very close to lagoon and the soil type also moisture. Already this residential type covers a small portion of the region but now a days that also reduce by these reasons. Overall, this Atchuvely region consist mix of residential types which have specific features, unique characteristics and different lifestyle of different social groups which are aligning with their social backgrounds.

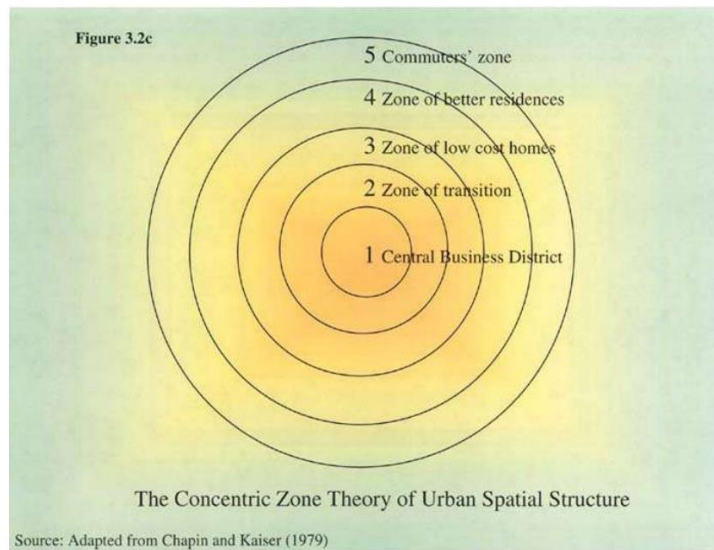
Applicability of Socio-Spatial Theories

Socio-spatial theories explains the distribution pattern of the residencials based on their income, affordability, and social values. There are 5 models explaining under socio-spatial theory.

1. Concentric zone theory
2. Sector theory
3. Combined concentric-sector theory
4. Multiple Nuclei theory
5. Alternative hypothesis theory

Considering the present situation of my study area, these exact models aren't observed in the context of town, because the actual nature of the urban areas does not match the assumptions made for these theories. The above residential zone map shows the scattered zones of residential type in Atchuvely town, but this region's zone pattern 80% match with Concentric zone theory. This theory posits that cities consist of concentric rings, with the central business district at the core, surrounded by transitional zones, working-class residential areas, and finally, affluent suburbs on the outermost ring. The theory suggests that land-use patterns and social organization are influenced by factors such as transportation and socioeconomic status, resulting in distinct zones with varying levels of prosperity and social conditions within a city.

Concentric Zone Theory (Earnest Burgess, 1920s)



Concentric zone theory can be applied for Atchuvely region.

Conclusion

Atchuvely is a town with residences belonging to Agricultural community, Fishing community and the residential next to the commercial area. and, people belonging different communities' clustered based on different housing patterns, and lifestyle. These residential patterns are slightly match to Concentric zone socio-spatial theory. So, this concentric zone theory can be applied to the Atchuvely region.